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DJIA 51481.51 ▼ 347.11 0.67% NASDAQ 26820.38 ▼ 0.9% STOXX 600 638.68 ▲ 0.01% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 15/32, yield 5.241% OIL \$92.60 ▲ \$0.19 GOLD \$4,135.40 ▼ \$150.80 EURO \$1.1373 YEN 157.38

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Goldman Sachs's board** has discussed a plan for David Solomon to step down as chief executive and be replaced with Chief Operating Officer John Waldron as soon as next year. **A1**
- ◆ **OpenAI scrapped the release** of its next-generation AI model over safety concerns that researchers raised during internal testing as the industry responds to agent misbehavior. **A1, B1**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks slumped** and the yield on the 10-year Treasury note reached a 19-year high. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow fell 0.8%, 0.9% and 0.7%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Nvidia's board** approved a \$150 billion increase to the company's share-repurchase program, bringing the total authorization to \$235 billion. **A1**
- ◆ **Nvidia introduced** a software platform to help developers test and deploy AI agents and keep them in a secure environment. **B4**
- ◆ **AMD agreed** to acquire artificial-intelligence research firm World Labs in an all-stock deal valued at about \$8.2 billion. **B1**
- ◆ **Citigroup tapped** Coinbase to help the bank's big clients take stablecoin payments from customers. **B1**
- ◆ **Meta Platforms** started a new business focused on selling AI tools to enterprise customers, aiming to build on the momentum of its Muse personal assistant. **B2**
- ◆ **SpaceX's Starship** entered orbit for the first time and deployed the latest version of its Starlink satellites, a step on the company's way to attracting commercial payloads. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Iran's ability** to choke off oil shipped through the Strait of Hormuz and use that as leverage in talks with the U.S. is dwindling, raising the risk it will resort to military escalation to improve its position. **A1**
- ◆ **Saudi Arabia resumed** exporting oil via its East-West pipeline after repairing damage caused by drone strikes. **A6**
- ◆ **A Senate panel report** said Iran has relied on digital dollars issued by the Tether cryptocurrency company to bypass U.S. sanctions. **A6**
- ◆ **One of FBI Director** Kash Patel's top deputies, Andrew Bailey, quit after roughly a year on the job, amid mass departures and other turmoil at the bureau. **A4**
- ◆ **The FAA will delay** certification of Boeing's latest 737 MAX model as air-safety regulators assess a new software glitch. **A3**
- ◆ **New York prosecutors** reopened an investigation into an alleged gang rape of a former Cornell student after her lawyer said in a lawsuit that the university failed to protect her. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** released a drastic rollback of regulations that require automakers to build cleaner, more fuel-efficient cars. **A3**
- ◆ **The Senate** overwhelmingly passed a bipartisan bill proposing sweeping changes to how college sports operate, including enshrining a cap on athlete pay. It faces an uphill battle in the House. **A4**
- ◆ **A court in Rome** sentenced three Egyptian security officials convicted of aggravated kidnapping in the abduction of an Italian researcher in Cairo to 10 years in prison. **A7**

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U.K. Probes Suspected Plot Targeting U.S. Forces



BEN BIRCHALL/PA WIRE/ZUMA PRESS

ON ALERT: Security was tight at RAF Fairford in England on Monday after authorities said an attack on the base that houses U.S. forces was foiled. Five suspects were released on bail as investigators probe whether Iran or an Islamist group was involved. **A6**

Mideast Oil Exports Rebound As Iran's Grip on Strait Eases

Volume recovers to 80% of prewar levels, but risk also mounts of Tehran escalation

By GEORGI KANTCHEV AND SUMMER SAID

DUBAI—Iran's ability to choke off oil flowing through the Strait of Hormuz—and use that as leverage in talks with the U.S.—is breaking down, raising the risk it will resort to military escalation to bolster its position.

The erosion of Iran's position comes as the U.S. Navy and

Gulf oil producers have gotten better at fending off or evading Iranian attacks, allowing more tankers to cross the strait.

Middle Eastern crude exports rebounded this month to around their highest level since the war began in February, oil data trackers say. Shipments via Hormuz and bypass routes were delivering just under 80% of their prewar regional flows as of last week, according to tracker Kpler.

So far this month, crude exports from major Middle Eastern producers including Saudi Arabia, Iraq, the U.A.E. and others—moving through Hormuz and alternative routes—

have risen to almost 13 million barrels a day. That is the highest total since February, when the region exported nearly 19 million barrels a day, according to ship tracker Huax.

Saudi Arabia is also starting to pump crude through its damaged East-West pipeline and load it on tankers in the Red Sea, though volumes remain reduced, officials familiar with the operations said. Some of the current output will be destined for domestic refineries, they said.

Iran, by contrast, has been unable to move crude through Hormuz since the U.S. reinstated its maritime blockade

in July. The stores of oil that Iran had stockpiled beyond the blockade could run out by mid-October, Kpler estimates, choking off a vital source of revenue as the country's economy buckles under the pressure of sanctions and the strain of war.

The shift weakens Tehran's ability to extract concessions by holding global energy supplies hostage, undercutting one of its most potent sources

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- ◆ **Saudis repair oil pipeline to Red Sea.....** **A6**
- ◆ **Oil prices, bond yields put damper on stocks.....** **B1**

Goldman Discusses Exit by CEO Solomon

By ANNAMARIA ANDRIOTIS AND EMILY GLAZER

The board of Goldman Sachs has discussed a plan for David Solomon to step down as chief executive and be replaced with Chief Operating Officer John Waldron as soon as next year, according to people familiar with the matter.

Discussions have involved Waldron, who is also the bank's president, taking over the top job around the end of 2027 or in 2028, the people said. Under the plan, Solomon is likely to be executive chairman of the Goldman board for around one to two years after

he steps down from the CEO role, some of the people said.

The plan requires approval by Goldman's board, which could occur in the coming months, some of the people familiar with the matter said, though the timing is fluid and subject to change.

Goldman spokesman Tony Fratto, who initially declined to comment on succession planning, said later Monday that the board regularly discusses succession and there is no definitive timeline.

The move would mark the end of Solomon's near decade atop the firm, which included

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INSIDE



ETRA SHAW/GETTY IMAGES

SPORTS

Baseball's best hitter stepped up to rescue the worst playoff team in history. **A14**

How Trump's Inflation, Rate Bets Backfired

Tariffs, war and an investment boom have complicated economic promises

By NICK TIMIRAO AND MERIDITH MCGRAW

In the early days of President Trump's second term, his economic advisers laid out a simple theory: Show the bond market that Washington was serious about closing its gaping deficits, and long-term interest rates would fall on their own. Trump could leave the Federal Reserve alone.

It hasn't worked out that way. Inflation is rising, the Fed

is raising rates and the 10-year Treasury yield is well above where it stood on Inauguration Day, when the new team blamed high rates on runaway Biden-era spending. Last week, that yield reached the highest level since 2007 as investors weighed a resilient economy, prolonged energy disruptions that threaten to aggravate price pressures and a central bank losing patience waiting for them to fade.

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Bouncers Wanted at Store's Pub

* * *
The bar at Lidl's in Northern Ireland is drawing crowds

By JAMES HOOKWAY

BELFAST—What if Walmart had a bar?

It's a question frazzled shoppers have pondered for years, wondering whether a few shots would help steel them for Black Friday. Others reckon it would have the chaotic charm of the "Star Wars" cantina. A balcony from which to view the mayhem at the tills below? Even better.

Those supermarket bar dreams are now a reality—at a Lidl in Northern Ireland. And it's all thanks to Northern Ire-

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OpenAI Scraps AI Model Over Safety Concerns

By MAXWELL ZEFF

OpenAI says it is scrapping the release of its next-generation artificial-intelligence model over safety concerns that researchers raised during internal testing, in one of the clearest signs so far that agent misbehavior could stymie the industry's rapid progression.

The move follows a summer punctuated by reports of AI systems across the industry going rogue, and marks a rare case of a major AI developer ditching a new release because of safety concerns.

The company had planned to launch the model, known as GPT-6.1 Astra, in the coming days or weeks, aiming for an October debut. The model was more capable than the company's previous models in completing challenging tasks from end-to-end without human as-

sistance, as well as writing.

The company will instead focus on improving the safety of future models, which it expects to be even more capable.

Saachi Jain, OpenAI's head of safety systems, said in an interview that GPT-6.1 Astra regressed in two areas and wasn't reliable enough to safely release. Compared with its predecessor, GPT-6 Astra, the model performed poorly on tests measuring alignment, or how well the model adheres to what humans would like it to do. Specifically, GPT-6.1 Astra showed higher levels of deception: The AI model wasn't always honest about telling users of the actions it did or did not take.

Another issue was what OpenAI calls "scope authorization"

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- ◆ **Top AI scientists are urging greater oversight.....** **B1**

Penn State Drug Ring Was Fueled by Hazing

By ASHLEY WONG AND JARED MITOVICH

Spring at Pennsylvania State University is rush season, when hopeful students vie for a spot in one of the school's many fraternities and sororities. At Delta Upsilon, for a short period, that meant prospects were instructed to cut and package cocaine inside the frat house and deliver the drugs across campus.

The instigator, according to former fraternity brothers' testimony before a Pennsylvania grand jury and criminal complaints filed by Pennsylvania police, was Thomas Robinson, a senior brother who showed the pledges how to break down a brick of cocaine, mix it with creatine and bag it, creating an at-home assembly line with protective equipment and a plastic folding table.

This was only one part of a larger campuswide drug ring that Pennsylvania authorities say ensnared 13 current and former students, five fraternities and even one frat brother's father before it all fell apart.

In December 2024, police raided Robinson's room in the Delta Upsilon house after informants revealed that the "new member educator," 22 years old at the time, was selling cocaine to his fraternity and others.

The code of silence baked into the Greek life brotherhood was broken after his dramatic arrest. Police in State College, Pa., where Penn State is located, linked Robinson to an "upper-level trafficking organization" that sourced drugs from Philadelphia and New York, the Pennsylvania attorney general said.

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